

How to use D&D Companion

A page-by-page walkthrough of every part of the app — where things live, how to set up a campaign and character, and, in detail, how to record and transcribe a live session from your microphone.

00 • GETTING STARTED

Launching the app

One command opens the full desktop app — Kestrel and the Electron window together, already pointed at your real data.

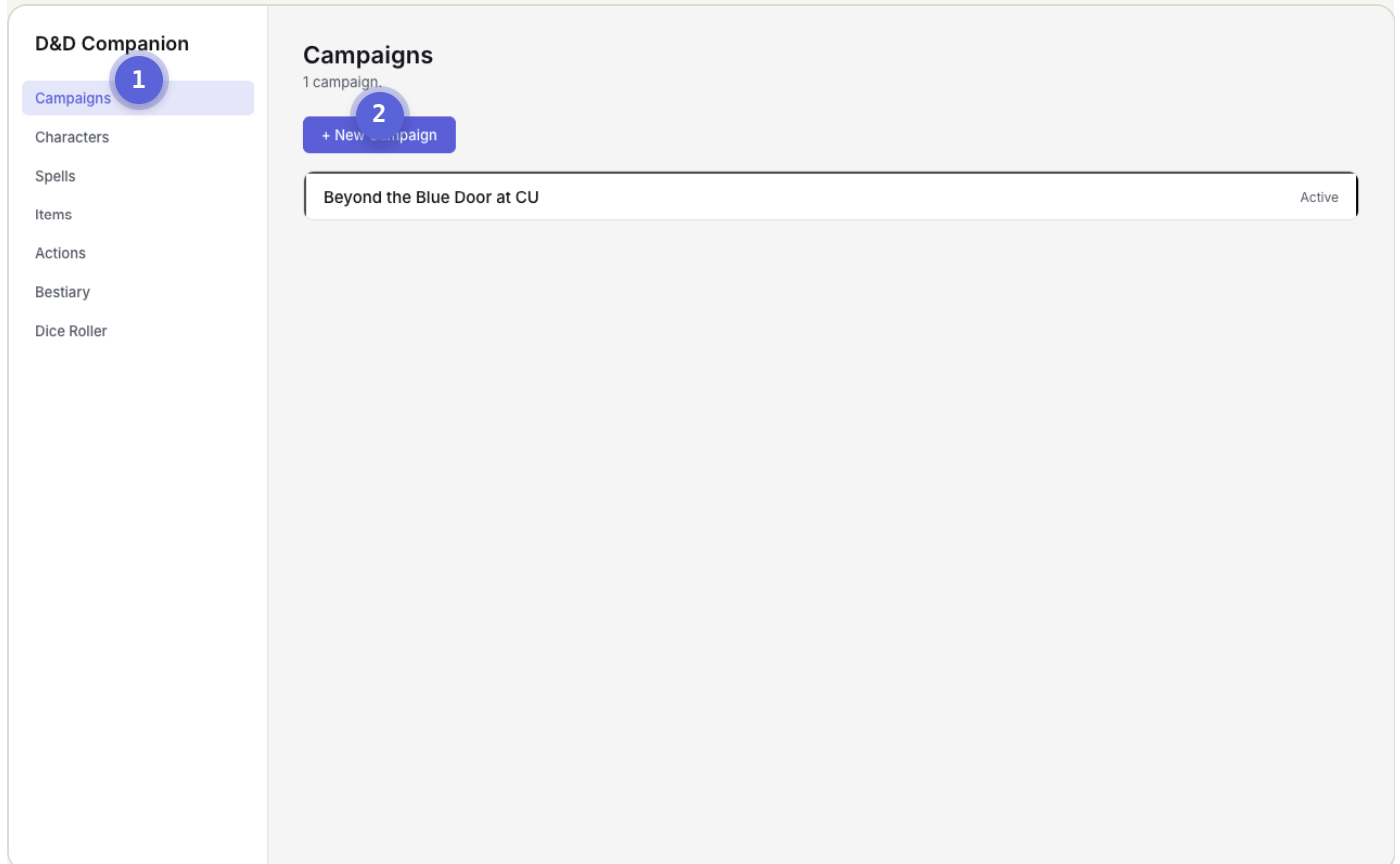
```
dnd-dev
```

If you only want to iterate in a browser tab instead of the Electron window,

`ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Development dotnet run --project src/DndCompanion.Host` works too — just don't drop the environment variable, or the page loads with nothing clickable.

Finding your way around

Every page hangs off the sidebar on the left. It never changes shape — campaigns and characters are your two starting points, everything else (spells, items, actions, the bestiary, the dice roller) is reference material you'll dip into from inside them.



- 1 Sidebar — every page in the app lives here
- 2 "+ New Campaign" — start here if this is a fresh install

Campaigns

A campaign is the container for everything about one game: who's playing, what encounters you've run, and the session-by-session log. Open one from the Campaigns list to get here.

D&D Companion

- Campaigns
- Characters
- Spells
- Items
- Actions
- Bestiary
- Dice Roller

← Back to Campaigns

Beyond the Blue Door at CU

Active · 1 character

1

Details
Edit

CU Boulder crew — basement portal campaign. 5 players total and 5 characters created

2

Characters

Baloney Slim

Aasimar · Druid Lv 1
Remove

3

Encounters
+ New Encounter

No encounters yet.

Sessions
+ New Session

Session Zero · July 27, 2026
Record

We're a group of college students at Colorado University. Near the basement, we found a set of double doors with an eerie blue light behind them. Opening them revealed what looked like a wavy, sparkling waterfall with no visible movement. We stepped through as a group and were immediately greeted by a HUD "create new character" modal — that's where I created Baloney Slim. There are 5 total players; the other players' names and stats will be added next session.

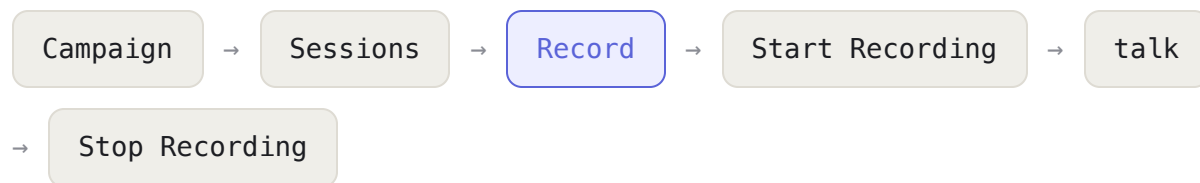
After character creation, we saw a tome on a pedestal with a floating gold pen writing our names onto a new page. As we read through the names

- 1 Characters — the party roster for this campaign
- 2 Encounters — combats you've set up or run (see Chapter 06)
- 3 Sessions — one entry per game night, with notes and a Record link

Details at the top of the page is editable — click **Edit** to change the campaign's name, notes, or active status. **Characters** is populated from the pool you build on the Characters page; adding one here just links it to this campaign, it doesn't create it.

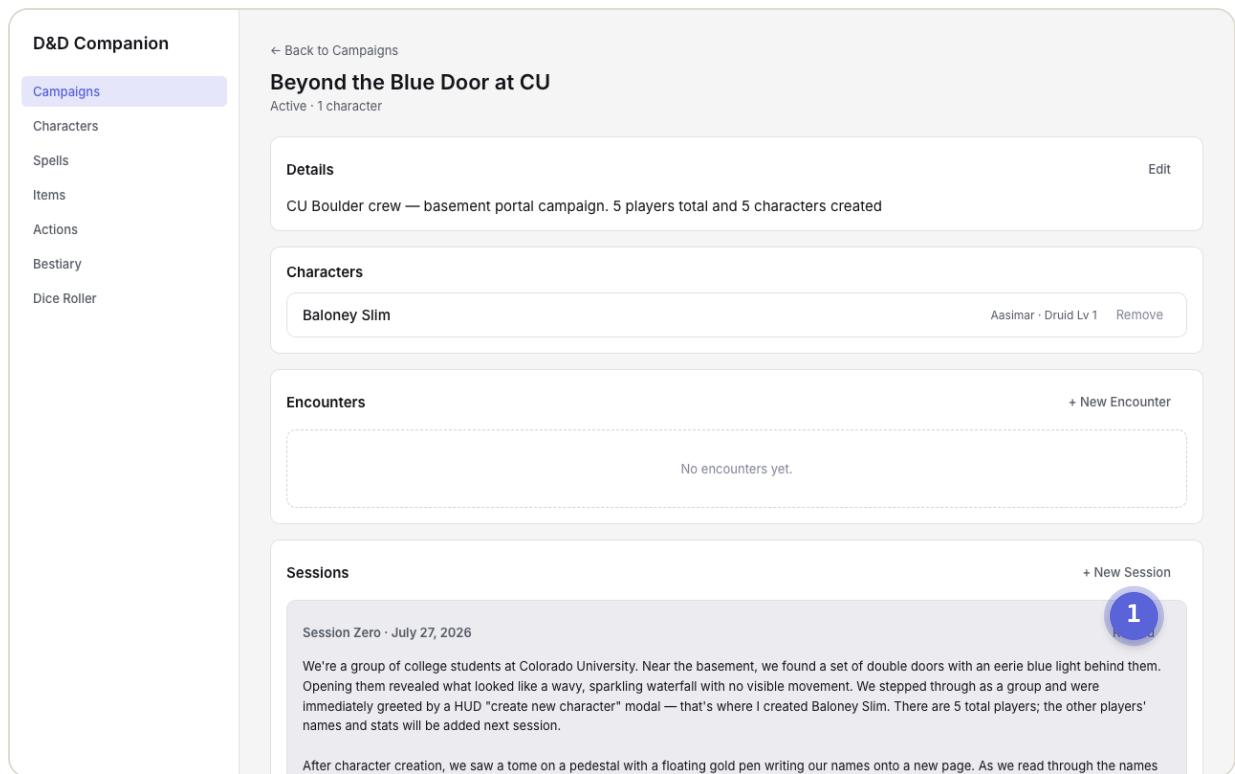
Recording a session

This is fully local: your mic audio is transcribed on this machine by Whisper.net and never leaves it. A local Ollama model then drafts short session notes from the transcript — always as an editable draft, never committed automatically.



1 Open the session you're about to play

From the campaign page, scroll to **Sessions**. Every session — past or newly created for tonight — has a **Record** link next to its date.



1 Click Record to open the recording page for this session

2 Start recording

On the recording page, click **Start Recording**. Your browser/OS will ask for microphone permission the first time — allow it. The very first recording on a fresh machine also downloads the Whisper model (about 148 MB), a one-time wait.

1 Start Recording

3 Play the game — it's listening

The button becomes **Stop Recording** and a **RECORDING...** badge appears. Nothing else to do — just play normally.

1 Click again when you're done — this saves the full session audio

2 Confirms the mic is live

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Watch the transcript and drafted notes fill in

Roughly every ten seconds of speech becomes a new line in **Live Transcript**. Roughly every sixty seconds, the local Ollama model reads the new transcript and drafts a few **Session Notes** — tagged Turn, Move, Action, Location, or Loot. Each one is editable and needs an explicit **Confirm** before it's treated as real; click **Discard** on anything not worth keeping.

Illustrative example content shown above — not an actual recording.

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Stop when the session's over

Click **Stop Recording**. The full audio is saved as a real **.wav** file on your machine and the session's transcript stays attached to it — you can come back to this page later to review it.

Heads up — there's no noise filtering yet, so Whisper will occasionally turn silence or background noise into a short, odd phrase in the transcript. That's a known limitation, not a bug: just ignore or discard those lines.

Characters

Characters exist independently of any one campaign — build the sheet once here, then link it into whichever campaign it's actually played in.

- 1 “+ New Character” — opens an inline creation form
- 2 Click a name to open that character’s sheet

The sheet itself covers identity, live combat stats, all eighteen skills, and spell slots.

- 1 Play — jumps to the at-the-table view (Chapter 05)
- 2 Combat — HP with quick damage/heal, AC, Speed, Initiative, Passive Perception

Skills & Saving Throws — toggle proficiency/expertise per skill; modifiers update live.

Spells — add from the SRD list or create a homebrew one; “Prepared” spells are what show up in Play.

Playing a session

The Play view (reached from a character sheet's [Play](#) button, or directly at </characters/{id}/play>) is what you keep open during the game.

- 1 Pick which session tonight's rolls get logged to
- 2 Roll any ability check or save with real modifiers, advantage/disadvantage

Every roll lands here — real polyhedral dice, not numbered boxes — with a one-click Log to session.

Save recurring rolls (like a specific spell's damage) into folders; "Roll All" fires and logs a whole folder at once.

Everything rolled — or typed as a free-text note — collects here in order, timestamped and tagged by source.

Running combat

Create an encounter from a campaign's **Encounters** section, add combatants — party members from the roster or freeform NPCs/monsters — then run initiative from there.

- 1 Sorts everyone by initiative and starts Round 1
- 1 Advance to the next combatant, skipping anyone Defeated
- 2 Current turn — the highlighted row

Each combatant row has a live HP field, a free-text conditions tag, and up/down arrows for resolving initiative ties by hand.

The bestiary

No SRD monster compendium ships with the app, so the Bestiary is where you build a reusable roster of the monsters and NPCs that actually recur in your game.

- 1 Create a new monster/NPC template

- 1 Save it for reuse in any future encounter

From an encounter's **Add Combatant** panel, "From Bestiary" drops one in with a rolled initiative — editing the template later never changes stats for a monster already in a fight.

Dice roller

A standalone roller at </dice-roller> — no character required. Every die renders as its real shape, not a number in a box.

- 1 Roll a Die — one tap for a single d4–d100
- 2 Check Roll — d20 + modifier, advantage/disadvantage
- 3 Custom Roll — any expression, e.g. 2d6+3

d4 triangle

d6 square

d8 diamond

d10 & d100 kite

d12 pentagon

d20 hexagon

D&D Companion is local-first — your campaigns, characters, recordings, and everything else live only on this machine.